

Sippara).’ This work was renewed by the father of Nebuchadnezzar (V. Scheil, Sippara, 1902, pp. 23, 65). It was intended for irrigation (cf. the reservoir at Assuan), but no doubt could also be used to flood the country against an invader. This must be the meaning of *δρυγμα πᾶν ἔλος* (§ 6), but H. has quite failed to understand his informant, and so his own account is most obscure. He seems to confuse the canals, along which his boat may well have travelled, with the great ‘basin’ which he only saw, and the uses of which were described to him.

ἐς τὸ ὕδωρ, ‘to the water level’; the phrase is Chaldaean (E. I. H. vii. 60).

- 5 κρηπίδα. Abydenus (*u. s.*) speaks of ‘great sluice-gates’ (ἐχέ-*τογνώμονες*).

H.’s account bears all the marks of an eyewitness; but possessed as he is by the Median terror, he pays no regard to the pacific use of the reservoir; hence he contradicts himself; he thinks of it as a marsh (*v. s.* and cf. 191. 3), but also as navigable.

- 7 κατὰ τοῦτο. Translate ‘In this way she wrought (in that part of) her country where were the entrances, and the shortest way from Media’; cf. iv. 136. 2 for τὰ σύντομα. The territory of Assyria was now in the Median hands (cf. for its being called ‘Media’ Xen. Anab. ii. 4. 27), and so the natural line of attack (ἐσβολαί) would be down the right bank of the Tigris.

- 186 1 ταῦτα μὲν. Translate ‘These were the defences with which she surrounded (her city) by digging (ἐκ βάθεος), but she took advantage of them to add such a supplementary work (παρενθήκην) as’ (the river wall and bridge).

- 2 Sayce (*ad loc.* and p. xxix) is very angry with H. for his mistake in speaking of ‘huge stones’ in Babylonia; but Nebuchadnezzar makes the same mistake (!) (E. I. H. ix. 24). Of course the stones were brought down the Euphrates from the north. Xenophon (Anab. i. 5. 5) speaks of a village on the Euphrates, where mill-stones were made for sale. Diodorus (ii. 8), who gives the bridge to Semiramis, makes it 5 stades long and 30 feet wide.

- 3 These ξύλα were no doubt a sort of drawbridge in the middle, pulled up on both sides; this feud (κλέπτοιεν) between the two river banks may be an unconscious echo of the rivalry between Babylon and her suburb, Borsippa.

- 187 2 Lehmann (Klio, i. 259) says the inscription uses the phraseology of the royal monuments; the οὐ γὰρ ἄμεινον, however, is quite Greek.

- 3 The presence of a dead body made the gate impassable for a Persian. Some see in the mention of ‘gates’ a contradiction to iii. 159. 1, but it is purely verbal (cf. 178. 2 n.). The story is a curious one; for treasures buried with the dead cf. Josephus, Ant. Jud. vii. 15. 3, pp. 392–4, who says that Solomon buried David with great treasures, and that when the tomb was robbed by Hyrcanus and by

Herod, they took away great wealth, but failed to find the real royal treasure. Lehmann (W. für K. P. 1900, p. 962) sees in H.'s story a confusion of Darius and Xerxes (cf. iii. 150 n.); he follows Aelian (V. H. xiii. 3), who tells a similar story, with additional marvels, of Xerxes violating the tomb of Belus. But A.'s version has every mark of being an explanation of οὐ γὰρ ἄμεινον, and Lehmann's theory is at best only possible. Stein thinks the tale may have arisen from a misunderstood inscription. All we can say for certain is that we see in it the Babylonian hatred of their conquerors.

- 188 I The last king of Babylon was called Nabonidus (556 B.C.); he was no relation of Nebuchadnezzar (d. 562); between them were three kings, of whom H. knows nothing.

The Choaspes is the 'river Ulai' of Daniel viii. 2. H. here gives an interesting point; the water of other lands was impure for the worshipper of Ormazd; hence the Choaspes water was taken both for drinking ('boiled') and for preparing the Haoma (cf. Indian Soma) libation (cf. vii. 54. 2 n.); for the earthly plant used for this, which corresponded to the white immortality-giving Haoma, cf. S. B. E. iv. 69.

- 189 I The Gyndes is the Diyâla, which runs into the Tigris from the north-east about fifty miles from Babylon; this identification is clear from v. 52. 5, where it is the next river to South.

For the Matieni cf. i. 72. 2 n. and iii. 94. 1. The Dardanians are otherwise unknown.

᾽Ωπις. H. mentions Opis because it is the highest point of navigation from the sea up the Tigris (Strabo, 739). Opis, which lay nearly fifty miles north of the Diyâla, at the junction of the Physcus and the Tigris (Xen. Anab. ii. 4. 25), was the scene of the Macedonian mutiny in 324 B.C.

συνψήσας: literally 'rub together', and so 'obliterate'. Here = 'sucking down'.

- 3 κατέτευε: i. e. his army. 'He extended it.' Maspero (iii. 635) accepts the story as partly true; Cyrus, he thinks, with the main army turned the defensive works on the north of Babylon, by lowering the water in the Tigris and the Gyndes. (Cf. Caes. B.C. i. 61 for a similar operation on the Sicoris in 49 B.C.) There was one battle (R. P. v². 162) near Opis, as H. says (190. 1), and it was immediately followed by a revolt in Akkad (i. e. N. Babylonia). Meantime Gobryas, marching down the left bank of the Gyndes with a portion of the army, took Babylon by treachery, while the main defensive force was resisting Cyrus. In the same way Prášek (i. 229) accepts the story of c. 191 as describing the preparations to intimidate the capital, and force a capitulation.

Even if these views be correct, the story told to H. was completely misleading; the city was taken by treachery (App. IV, § 6). But it is more likely that H. is partly right (as thus suggested) than that the whole narrative is an invention borrowed from the irriga-

tion works on the Gyndes (as Sir H. Rawlinson, *ad loc.*). The form it takes is religious in colouring; 'white horses' were sacred to the sun (iii. 90. 3 n.; cf. vii. 40. 4); hence the offending river is divided into as many channels (360) as there are days in the year.

190 I The war lasted longer than H. thinks; it perhaps began in 546 B.C., as the annals of Nabonidus seem to speak of an attack on Akkad (i.e. N. Babylonia) from Elam in that year (R. P. v². 161); but the record is much mutilated.

2 προεσάξαντο. The use of this word in viii. 20. 1 seems to show that it is from προσάπτω, 'they packed up beforehand,' not from προεσάγω (as Schweighäuser); cf. v. 34. 1 n.

191 2 ἅπασαν. Used loosely for 'the main army', as two other contingents are at once mentioned.

3 ἕλος. Cf. 185. 4, 5 nn.

ὑπονοστήσαντος, 'when the river had sunk' (cf. iv. 62. 2).

6 For Aristotle's account of the capture of Babylon, which even exaggerates the one here, cf. 178. 2 n.

ὁρτήν. The 'feast' agrees with the well-known story in Dan. v. πρῶτον. H. calls it 'the first' capture, in contrast to that by Darius (iii. 158). No doubt, however, he heard in Babylon nothing of Assyrian captures, e.g. by Assurbanipal in 648 B.C.

192-200 The account of the Babylonian land and people.

192 I τροφήν. This general payment in kind is not mentioned in iii. 90-5; the only corn contribution there (91. 3) is that of Egypt. The omission of the corn-tax in Bk. III goes to show (what is antecedently probable) that H. is there quoting an official document, drawn up for one special purpose, not giving an account of the whole revenue system. The corn contribution here mentioned corresponds to the Roman (1) *frumentum in cellam* (for the governor and his suite); but this was paid for; (2) *annona militaris* (for the soldiers in the province); (3) *annona civica*, i.e. for Rome, from Egypt and Africa (Marquardt, *Staats-V.* ii. 189, 232-3). For contributions in kind in Persia cf. Theop. frs. 124-5 (F. H. G. i. 298) and Meyer, iii. 51.

2 For the use of Ἀσσυρίη cf. 178. 1 n. For σατραπήν cf. iii. 89. 1 n. This Tritantaechmes, who was clearly satrap of Babylon when H. was there, is to be distinguished from the nephew of Darius (vii. 82); for his father Artabazus cf. viii. 126 and ix. *pass.*

3 As the μέδιμνος held 48 χοίνικες, the 'artaba' held 51, i.e. about 13 gallons. A χοίνιξ of wheat was a man's daily allowance, vii. 187. 2. For its size cf. vi. 57 n.

4 For the hunting dogs see Rawlinson, *ad loc.* (with illustration).

Ctesias (Ind. 5, p. 248) says they were able to cope with a lion, a characteristic exaggeration. M. Polo (ii. 19; i. 400) says the Great Khan had about 10,000 hunting dogs.

193 1 H. is describing the Babylonian plain proper, i.e. the southern

part of Mesopotamia; at the present time the Euphrates and the Tigris unite in the Shat-El-Arab, but originally they reached the sea separately.

ῥέται. Rain, which is abundant in Assyria proper, falls in Babylonia chiefly in the winter and spring, and then as a rule not in large quantities. Willcocks' table (Irrigation of Mesopotamia, 1910, p. 68) shows that from May to October the land is practically rainless, in the other six months the rainfall is about eight inches, fairly evenly distributed. So far as rain is concerned the country is not a desert like Egypt, but rather a 'steppe region capable of sustaining millions of sheep' (p. 10). Grote (iii. 295) lays stress on the accuracy of H. in contrasting the light rains here with practically rainless Upper Egypt (iii. 10 n.). H. is quite right in saying that while the scanty spring rain (τοῦτο) 'causes the corn to sprout, the crop ripens from irrigation'. His description of this is accurate, if we remember that he is contrasting the natural (αὐτοῦ τοῦ ποταμοῦ) Nile flood with the artificial Babylonian system. The present Euphrates, however, now that the canals are gone, floods its banks from March to July, when the Armenian snows melt.

κλωνήροισι, 'by swipes worked by hand' (cf. vi. 119. 3), i.e. the shadoofs which are still used in Mesopotamia and Egypt (cf. Maspero, i. 764, and 340 for illustrations). Colonel Chesney (Survey of Tig. and Euph. 1850, ii. 653) describes it as a wooden lever, 13-15 feet long, revolving on a post 3-4 feet high with a bucket at the end, balanced when full by a weight at the other end. From the top of the bank the water was distributed over the fields in artificial channels.

- 2 For the canals cf. c. 184 n. The canal here is the 'royal canal' restored by Nebuchadnezzar, which ran south-east from above Babylon to the Tigris, near the later Seleucia.

πρὸς ἥλιον τὸν χειμερινόν. The ancients divided the sky into

ἀνατολή and δυσμὴ ἱσημερινή = E. and W.

ἀνατολή and δυσμὴ θερυνή = NE. and NW.

ἀνατολή and δυσμὴ χειμερινή = SE. and SW.

(cf. Arist. Meteor. ii. 6 *ad init.*, where a diagram is given). Here ἥλιος = ἀνατολή (cf. vii. 70. 1 οἱ ἀπὸ ἡλίου Αἰθίοπες).

- 3 H. is contrasting broadly and rightly the treeless cornland of Babylonia with Greece.

Strabo (742 *ad fin.*) says 'three hundredfold', without H.'s careful limitation. Lehmann (Fest. für Kiepert, 1898, pp. 305 seq.) argues that the accounts of H. and of Strabo are borrowed independently from Hecataeus (cf. c. 199 n.). His arrangement of the two accounts in parallel columns is useful, though his argument quite breaks down.

φύλλα, 'blades.' Ancient (e.g. Theophrastus, viii. 7. 4) and modern writers confirm H. as to the fertility of Babylonia; so Chesney (ii. 602) says 'those portions which are still cultivated, as